



35 Open Source Apps for Mac Users

Mac users now have more options to enjoy the pleasures of freedom. This article takes a look at some of the major open source applications that cater to them.

Yes, you read that right. No matter what the warlords at Apple may tell you, you can run open source apps even if you are using Mac OS, which itself is closed source.

Wondering why you ought to choose open source? Well, for a start, owning a Mac is an expensive proposition, so opting for open source applications on the Mac is one decision your wallet will appreciate. Second, it is common knowledge that open source applications are updated more frequently, are community-driven, and easily customisable. What more can one ask for?

The Internet

Mozilla Firefox: Seriously, who doesn't know Firefox?

It is one of the leading open source Web browsers (and it eats Safari for lunch). Definitely one of the most loved applications, irrespective of your platform!

Link: <http://www.mozilla.org/en-US/firefox/new/>

Chromium: If you are using Mac OS, chances are that you've opted for Google Chrome, instead of its open source sibling, Chromium. However, just for your information, if you need a true open source browser for the Mac, you can take a look at Chromium.

Link: www.chromium.org

Adium: This is an open source messenger that lets you connect to multiple IM platforms, such as AOL and GTalk (via Jabber). If you are a social networking addict and like to chat with your friends online, Adium can come in handy.

Link: <http://adiumx.com/>

Mozilla Thunderbird: Here's an email suite-cum-calendar-

and-planner. It comes loaded with features such as powerful spam filters, easier email management, task planning, and more.

Link: <http://www.mozilla.org/products/thunderbird/>

RSSOwl: This is a cross-platform RSS client that lets you easily manage and read your RSS subscriptions.

Link: <http://www.rssowl.org/download>

Vienna: Here's yet another RSS client, modelled along the lines of RSSOwl.

Link: <http://www.vienna-rss.org/vienna2.php>

Juice: Do you happen to be a creative artist? If you use the Internet to showcase your work using podcasts, you won't find a better podcasting tool for Mac than Juice. It is totally free and open source, so give it a spin!

Link: <http://juicereceiver.sourceforge.net/index.php>

Colloquy: This is a free and open source IRC client for the Mac.

Link: <http://colloquy.info/downloads.html>

Office suites and productivity

Bean: If you need a word processor for general use (creating and editing documents, dealing with multiple file formats like DOC, ODT and RTF, and so on), but do not wish to opt for super-expensive suites like MS Office, Bean should be worth a try. It is an open source word processor for Mac users, and comes loaded with great features.

Link: <http://www.bean-osx.com/Bean.html>

AbiWord: Here's yet another open source and totally free word processor.

Link: <http://www.abisource.com/download/>

LibreOffice: If a mere word processor won't do for you, instead of burning money on proprietary office suites, take a look at LibreOffice.